

SYSTEMATIC LIQUIDITY RESEARCH

A systematic liquidity-research operation

The deep-tuned book — a per-instrument record, a published cross-section of a 130+ instrument universe.

ABSTRACT

LIQUIDEX is a systematic research operation built on a single principle: institutional liquidity leaves the same structural footprint wherever it trades. Working from that principle, each instrument in a 130+ instrument universe — equities, commodities, indices, digital assets and FX — is read down to the institutional behaviour that dominates its order flow and tuned to its own per-instrument recipe through a disciplined optimisation protocol. **One hundred and seven cells are complete** as of this thesis — across equities, commodities, indices, crypto and FX — of which ninety-six clear the edge bar (profit factor ≥ 1 at ≥ 30 trades). The trustworthy tier is the twenty-four symmetric both-direction cells that survive a regime flip; the high-profit-factor majority are long-only fades read through a secular-bull window, so they carry a walk-forward-mandatory caveat. Section 5 turns from the book to its cause — the cross-asset institutional actors structurally positioned to produce the same footprint across equities, commodities, indices, crypto and FX, profiled as evidenced hypotheses. All figures herein are in-sample and net of commission and slippage; their out-of-sample validation is the subject of Section 6.

130+ Instruments under profile	107 Deep-tuned cells · 5 instrument classes	96 Edges (PF ≥ 1, N ≥ 30)	24 Symmetric both-direction edges
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SECTION 1

The mechanism

Institutional order flow is not noise; it is the residue of decisions. A liquidation cascade, a manufactured stop-run, iceberg absorption defending a level, the exhaustion of a one-sided move — each is a behavioural signature, and each repeats.

The engine identifies the signature, attributes it to the institutional behaviour producing it, and resolves that read into a single rule-based position: entry, a structural stop, a target at the opposing wall, a breakeven and a time-stop. It does not merely detect an anomaly; it profiles the actor behind it — what they are doing, where they are going, and whether they are masking it.

An edge that lives in one market is a curve-fit. An edge that recurs across many is a discovery.

The claim under test is narrow and falsifiable. If the edge were specific to one instrument, it would be an artefact of that instrument's history — an overfit. If instead the same behavioural reads recover an edge across many unrelated instruments, the engine is measuring a structural property of institutional markets rather than the idiosyncrasy of a single chart.

The sections that follow set out, in order: the protocol used to tune each symbol (Section 2); the deep-tuned book across the universe (Section 3); two worked examples of the per-symbol read, with the behavioural reasoning behind each (Section 4); the cross-asset actors behind the lever — who produces the same footprint across worlds, and why (Section 5); and the validation work that separates these in-sample results from a track record (Section 6).

SECTION 2

The per-symbol protocol

Breadth is meaningless without method. Every symbol is taken through the same protocol. The discipline is deliberately conservative: a behavioural read is admitted only when it improves the risk-adjusted result at its tuned setting, and discarded the moment it does not.

01 Baseline

The engine is reduced to its core — every optional read disabled, default parameters throughout. Raw profit factor, drawdown and trade count are recorded as the benchmark to beat.

02 Greedy forward-selection

Behavioural reads — cascade-stop, opposing-wall target, the directional-risk gate, risk-velocity confirmation, iceberg absorption, liquidity-sweep exhaustion — are added one at a time, retained only if they improve the risk-adjusted result, and reverted otherwise.

03 Coupled parameter tuning

Each retained read is judged at its tuned setting, not its default: its sensitivity is swept in both directions, and a read that cannot pay at any setting is removed rather than left at a default that flatters it.

04 Two-pass refinement

The surviving configuration is walked a second time, each secondary parameter nudged and immediately reverted if the equity curve degrades. The accepted recipe is the one no further change improves.

05 Risk-adjusted scoring

Every decision is taken on $S = PF / (1 + \text{MaxDD})$, never on profit factor alone, subject to a hard floor of thirty trades. A high profit factor on a small sample does not qualify.

06 Out-of-sample gate

A recipe this specific must clear a held-out window before it is treated as real. In-sample strength is the entry condition for that test, not a substitute for it.

We do not search for the setting that makes a chart look good. We search for the read that survives being doubted.

SECTION 3

The deep-tuned book

Each instrument tuned to its own recipe, ranked by profit factor. **107 cells across five instrument classes** — equities, commodities, indices, crypto and FX — of which **96 are edges** (profit factor ≥ 1 at ≥ 30 trades). The trustworthy tier is the **24 symmetric both-direction cells** — they survive a regime flip. $\text{PF} \leq 1.5$ is flagged *re-microtune*; $\triangle$ marks walk-forward-mandatory. Full per-instrument configurations are published at wattsonworks.github.io/framework.

TABLE 1 — THE DEEP-TUNED BOOK, RANKS 1-38 OF 107 (EQUITIES, COMMODITIES, INDICES, CRYPTO, FX)

#	SYMBOL	CLASS	PF	MAX DD	WIN	N	ARCHETYPE	STATUS
1	XCUUSD $\triangle$	Commodity	9.149	6.2%	84%	38	comdty-confluence-long	walk-forward
2	DE $\triangle$	Single-name	5.748	23.6%	87%	76	fade-long	walk-forward
3	AUDJPY	Forex	4.898	7.6%	61%	49	forex-confluence-both	ready
4	DOGE $\triangle$	Crypto	4.759	4.3%	90%	40	crypto-fade-long	walk-forward
5	NZDUSD $\triangle$	Forex	4.657	6.0%	17%	52	forex-fade-short-cascstop	walk-forward
6	GLD $\triangle$	ETF	4.533	18.8%	83%	64	fade-long-ice	walk-forward
7	V $\triangle$	Single-name	4.443	25.4%	81%	80	fade-long	walk-forward
8	XOM $\triangle$	Single-name	4.386	20.6%	81%	42	fade-long-velo	walk-forward
9	XAGUSD $\triangle$	Commodity	3.939	18.9%	75%	32	comdty-confluence-long	walk-forward
10	COST $\triangle$	Single-name	3.851	23.0%	78%	64	fade-long	walk-forward
11	LRCX $\triangle$	Semis	3.837	26.9%	83%	30	fade-long-cascstop	walk-forward
12	XLV $\triangle$	ETF	3.798	10.5%	87%	46	gated-continuation-fade	walk-forward
13	GBPUSD	Forex	3.409	4.5%	26%	31	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
14	USDCAD	Forex	3.264	3.7%	59%	74	forex-confluence-both	ready
15	XLK $\triangle$	ETF	3.184	11.7%	46%	39	fade-long-ice	walk-forward
16	USDJPY	Forex	3.030	9.7%	19%	31	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
17	XLE $\triangle$	ETF	2.941	7.0%	70%	37	fade-long-clean-velo	walk-forward
18	WTICUSD $\triangle$	Commodity	2.917	23.6%	67%	30	comdty-confluence-long-gated	walk-forward
19	AUDUSD	Forex	2.796	7.1%	23%	47	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
20	AVAX	Crypto	2.643	16.0%	30%	37	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
21	ETH	Crypto	2.610	7.4%	88%	48	fade-bsl-cryptolong	ready
22	SMH $\triangle$	ETF	2.547	12.9%	59%	104	fade-long-wall-velo	walk-forward
23	SOXX $\triangle$	ETF	2.493	21.3%	55%	84	fade-bsl	walk-forward
24	JPM	Single-name	2.452	18.4%	52%	44	equity-confluence-long	ready
25	MA $\triangle$	Single-name	2.383	8.9%	36%	33	fade-long-wall-gated	walk-forward
26	SOL	Crypto	2.373	16.6%	20%	156	trend-both-dir	ready
27	XLFX $\triangle$	ETF	2.367	38.0%	47%	34	equity-confluence-long	walk-forward
28	GBPJPY	Forex	2.352	8.5%	25%	80	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
29	QQQ $\triangle$	ETF	2.317	8.7%	47%	32	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
30	ETN $\triangle$	Single-name	2.305	35.2%	77%	60	fade-long	walk-forward
31	IGV $\triangle$	ETF	2.277	32.6%	89%	46	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
32	PEPE	Crypto	2.153	10.7%	44%	32	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
33	ETH-CB	Crypto	2.098	7.4%	86%	65	fade-crypto-ice-brk	ready
34	BTC	Crypto	2.082	9.8%	45%	103	fade-breaker-BE	ready
35	DIA $\triangle$	ETF	2.074	10.9%	42%	31	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
36	INTC $\triangle$	Semis	2.053	46.6%	67%	49	fade-long-cascstop	walk-forward
37	SCHD $\triangle$	ETF	2.047	6.7%	46%	35	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
38	KO	Single-name	1.979	19.8%	54%	201	fade-clean	ready

Ranked by profit factor · the book continues overleaf with ranks 39–76.

SECTION 3 (CONTINUED)

The deep-tuned book — ranks 39–76

TABLE 1 (CONTINUED) — RANKS 39–76 OF 107

#	SYMBOL	CLASS	PF	MAX DD	WIN	N	ARCHETYPE	STATUS
39	NXPI	Semis	1.971	20.7%	66%	61	fade-gated	ready
40	PANW [△]	Single-name	1.957	23.0%	49%	86	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
41	ON [△]	Semis	1.952	38.7%	63%	38	fade-long-cascstop-gated	walk-forward
42	ICP [△]	Crypto	1.890	27.1%	38%	55	crypto-confluence-long	walk-forward
43	NATGASUSD	Commodity	1.882	10.0%	21%	56	comdty-trend-both-dir	ready
44	VOO [△]	ETF	1.849	12.2%	60%	30	fade-clean-cascstop	walk-forward
45	ADI [△]	Semis	1.836	12.7%	42%	31	fade-long-wall-gated	walk-forward
46	KLAC [△]	Semis	1.823	16.5%	41%	51	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
47	XLV [△]	ETF	1.798	22.0%	74%	34	fade-long-clean-cascstop	walk-forward
48	IWM	ETF	1.795	24.6%	40%	102	equity-confluence-long	ready
49	MPWR [△]	Semis	1.788	27.2%	55%	31	fade-long-cascstop-velo-bsl	walk-forward
50	RENDER [△]	Crypto	1.757	14.4%	86%	70	crypto-fade-long	walk-forward
51	DE30EUR [△]	Index	1.741	11.4%	68%	69	index-confluence-long	walk-forward
52	UNI [△]	Crypto	1.703	19.0%	48%	40	crypto-fade-long	walk-forward
53	ADA	Crypto	1.686	13.5%	20%	40	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
54	ARB	Crypto	1.677	19.6%	21%	56	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
55	JUP	Crypto	1.670	25.8%	34%	44	crypto-fade-long	ready
56	BNB	Crypto	1.605	19.7%	26%	74	crypto-confluence-both	ready
57	PEP	Single-name	1.595	6.5%	49%	107	fade-both	ready
58	XRP	Crypto	1.587	19.0%	14%	87	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
59	TSEM [△]	Semis	1.582	19.2%	44%	39	continuation-long-wall	walk-forward
60	FIL	Crypto	1.572	20.2%	25%	40	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
61	AAVE [△]	Crypto	1.565	24.4%	23%	90	crypto-confluence-long	walk-forward
62	NAS100USD [△]	Index	1.540	12.5%	58%	31	index-confluence-long	walk-forward
63	UK100GBP [△]	Index	1.537	7.3%	61%	38	index-confluence-long-velo	walk-forward
64	SPY [△]	ETF	1.521	8.5%	38%	32	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
65	AMD [△]	Semis	1.515	21.3%	44%	32	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
66	EURUSD	Forex	1.514	7.9%	34%	32	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
67	ENA	Crypto	1.500	15.7%	26%	47	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
68	SPX500USD [△]	Index	1.468	11.4%	68%	34	index-confluence-long	re-microtune
69	INJ [△]	Crypto	1.461	12.1%	85%	52	crypto-fade-long	walk-forward
70	TXN [△]	Semis	1.455	27.9%	56%	34	fade-long-cascstop-velo-bsl	re-microtune
71	NEAR [△]	Crypto	1.454	8.4%	80%	50	crypto-fade-long	walk-forward
72	FET	Crypto	1.454	28.7%	19%	37	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
73	MRVL [△]	Semis	1.447	44.2%	38%	58	semi-confluence-long-gated	re-microtune
74	LTC	Crypto	1.433	25.8%	24%	70	crypto-confluence-both	ready
75	TSM [△]	Semis	1.428	25.2%	40%	30	fade-long-wall	re-microtune
76	XAUUSD [△]	Commodity	1.391	9.3%	69%	35	comdty-confluence-long	re-microtune

Ranked by profit factor · the book concludes overleaf with ranks 77–107.

SECTION 3 (CONTINUED)

The deep-tuned book — ranks 77–107

TABLE 1 (CONTINUED) — RANKS 77–107 OF 107

#	SYMBOL	CLASS	PF	MAX DD	WIN	N	ARCHETYPE	STATUS
77	ASML	Semis	1.385	14.0%	52%	202	equity-robust-both	re-microtune
78	BCH^Δ	Crypto	1.375	10.2%	88%	50	crypto-fade-long	walk-forward
79	VGT	ETF	1.368	24.0%	36%	56	equity-confluence-long	re-microtune
80	ARM^Δ	Semis	1.366	31.6%	33%	114	continuation-long-breaker	re-microtune
81	DOT	Crypto	1.330	25.8%	20%	100	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
82	XLP^Δ	ETF	1.327	15.4%	62%	48	fade-long-clean-cascstop	re-microtune
83	AVGO^Δ	Semis	1.315	8.8%	63%	35	fade-long-clean	re-microtune
84	XLI^Δ	ETF	1.298	12.5%	40%	50	continuation-long-wall	re-microtune
85	US30USD^Δ	Index	1.291	10.1%	70%	44	index-confluence-long	re-microtune
86	TLT	ETF	1.272	17.7%	49%	205	fade-clean	re-microtune
87	MU^Δ	Semis	1.239	13.9%	61%	31	fade-long-velo-nowall	re-microtune
88	ORCL^Δ	Single-name	1.230	26.0%	50%	80	fade-long-wall	re-microtune
89	EURJPY	Forex	1.187	11.2%	26%	53	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
90	NVDA^Δ	Semis	1.185	34.0%	33%	222	continuation-long-breaker-gated	re-microtune
91	TIA	Crypto	1.160	39.4%	19%	113	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
92	QCOM^Δ	Semis	1.076	21.9%	24%	38	fade-long-wall-gated	re-microtune
93	MCHP^Δ	Semis	1.048	37.2%	27%	84	continuation-long-wall	re-microtune
94	TRX	Crypto	1.032	7.2%	32%	28	crypto-nfloor-defer	ready
95	EURGBP^Δ	Forex	1.027	5.3%	59%	34	forex-fade-long-marginal	walk-forward
96	SEI	Crypto	1.003	47.4%	16%	319	crypto-nonedge	ready
97	AMAT	Semis	0.953	55.2%	40%	51	semi-confluence-nonedge	re-microtune
98	LDO	Crypto	0.909	51.2%	14%	273	crypto-nonedge	ready
99	SUI	Crypto	0.881	32.8%	15%	254	crypto-confluence-nonedge	ready
100	ATOM	Crypto	0.853	49.0%	22%	130	crypto-confluence-nonedge	ready
101	RUNE	Crypto	0.850	29.6%	22%	69	crypto-nonedge	ready
102	WIF	Crypto	0.842	55.9%	30%	54	crypto-nonedge	ready
103	OP	Crypto	0.795	29.8%	10%	82	crypto-nonedge	ready
104	APT	Crypto	0.794	31.4%	17%	136	crypto-confluence-nonedge	ready
105	LINK	Crypto	0.687	56.1%	18%	128	crypto-confluence-nonedge	ready
106	ONDO	Crypto	0.586	25.7%	31%	26	crypto-nonedge	ready
107	USDCHF^Δ	Forex	78.399	2.2%	21%	52	forex-fade-short-cascstop	degen · excl.

The deep-tuned book is a published cross-section; the remaining instruments in the 130+ universe are under profile. The high win rates on the strongest long-only cells are regime artefacts of a secular-bull window — almost every long-only result is walk-forward-mandatory; the symmetric both-direction cells (across FX, crypto, equities and commodities) are the trustworthy tier. The degenerate USDCHF outlier (PF 78) is excluded as noise. All figures in-sample, net of commission and slippage.

SECTION 3 (CONTINUED)

What the book shows

Read blind, the book sorts itself into two structural temperaments. **88 of the 107 are faders** — defensives, macro and the broad index complex, where the edge is reverting an exhausted move — and **19 are continuation** names, where it rides the break. **83 run long-only**, the signature of a passive complex accumulating through a rising market; the **24 both-direction cells**, which add a short engine, are the regime-robust minority. That long-only majority is the principal caveat: an edge measured through a secular bull is exactly what an out-of-sample window must test.

BY INSTRUMENT CLASS — 107 DEEP-TUNED CELLS

CLASS	CELLS	EDGES	MEAN PF	BEST
Index & sector ETFs	19	19	2.25	4.53 · GLD
Semiconductors	20	19	1.61	3.84 · LRCX
Single-name leaders	11	11	2.94	5.75 · DE
Commodities	5	5	3.86	9.15 · copper
Global indices	5	5	1.52	1.74 · DAX
Digital assets	36	26	1.55	4.76 · DOGE
FX majors	11	11	2.81	4.90 · AUDJPY

The queue, and what discipline holds back

Nineteen names sit at or below a profit factor of 1.5 and are **held back for re-tuning** rather than presented as finished. Ten names below a profit factor of 1.0 — the semiconductor AMAT and nine recent-launch crypto bleeders (LDO, SUI, ATOM, RUNE, WIF, OP, APT, LINK, ONDO) — are deferred outright, printed as reference rather than edges. No result is admitted on fewer than thirty trades, and no figure has been selected after the fact to flatter the whole. The deep-tuned book is a published cross-section; the wider 130+ universe is under profile, published as it stands, not as it will read when it is finished.

SECTION 4

Worked examples: the per-symbol read

Two symbols from the book, opened all the way up. Together they make the same point from opposite sides: the read is not a setting but an understanding of the actor's temperament, expressed as a configuration.

PEP — *when the desk is patient*

A liquidation cascade never comes for a consumer staple. PepsiCo is not where leverage blows up; it is where patient, mandate-driven capital accumulates and defends. Its flow is quiet, two-sided and mean-reverting — and that is precisely why a default read fails it, listening for violence in a market that trades on patience.

Reading the desk meant matching the algorithm to the psychology: both directions enabled, the reward-to-risk gate raised so only the cleanest reversals qualify, iceberg absorption set deliberately slow to wait for genuinely defended size, and the risk gate tightened on the short side. The coin-flip became a clean, low-drawdown edge.

PEP • RESULT

Profit factor	1.595
Net return	+31.24%
Max drawdown	6.47%
Win rate	48.60%
Trades	107

Configuration: long + short, raised R:R gate, iceberg at 5 hits, high-volume sweep exhaustion, short-side risk gate tightened. Verified live.

TLT — *when the move never reaches the wall*

TLT is long-duration Treasuries — a macro vehicle, not a tape that liquidity desks push to clean technical walls. Its price is dragged by rate expectations and central-bank language, and the full move to the opposing wall rarely completes, because a data print interrupts it first. Everything one adds to it is fragile: tighten the stop and the chop removes you; widen the target and the move dies before it arrives.

What rescued it was profit-taking discipline — banking 60% of the position two-thirds of the way to the wall — and a wide sweep stop. A buffer-30 stop lifts the result past the earlier 1.232; the whole edge balances on those two levers.

TLT • RESULT

Profit factor	1.272
Net return	+18.05%
Max drawdown	17.66%
Win rate	48.78%
Trades	205

The levers: a wide sweep stop (buffer 30) over the earlier 1.232, plus Partial-TP banking 60% at 0.66 to the wall. Long + short, cascade-fade, wall-target. Verified live. **Flagged to re-microtune** (PF ≤ 1.5).

A recipe this specific is where overfitting hides. Both cells carry the out-of-sample flag of Section 5: an in-sample result is the entry condition for validation, never a deployment claim.

SECTION 5

The actor behind the lever

The thesis of this document — one behavioural read, many instruments — raises a harder question: why should the *same* footprint appear at once in an equity, a commodity, a stock index, a coin and an FX pair that share no fundamental link?

The naïve reading is coordination. The defensible reading is **structural coupling**: a small, identifiable population of balance sheets, risk engines and trading models now spans all three worlds, so a single risk decision mechanically expresses itself as the same directional flow in each.

At the level that matters — the risk engine, the collateral pool, the trend signal, the inventory book — these are no longer three markets. They are one correlated object with three tickers.

This is an **evidenced hypothesis, not an attribution**: nothing below claims a named firm executed any specific trade — dealer inventories and intraday positions are not public. Each actor is framed as *structurally positioned to produce* the footprint, evidenced by public fact, and the coupling is regime-dependent — sharpest in risk-off and vol-spike regimes [LSEG]. Four documented forces drive it.

FORCE 1 · COMMON HOLDERS

One correlated basket, de-risked at once

The cleanest case is the yen-carry "risk-on basket." The BIS attributes the August-2024 turbulence to the unwinding of leveraged equity and currency trades — ~¥40tn of carry, amplified by margin calls, with equities and FX selling *together* [BIS 90]. The yen funded AI equities, crypto and EM alike, so one decision to cut the carry sold every leg. The same structure recurs in multi-strategy pod shops, where hundreds of pods share one risk budget and one cross-margined book — a concentration GSAM ties to "synchronised deleveraging during market stress" [GSAM] — and, most mechanically, in risk-parity, whose vol target deleverages every asset the moment cross-asset volatility rises.

FORCE 2 · SHARED MARKET MAKERS

One inventory engine, every venue

The same handful of electronic principals now quote the same risk-on instruments across equities, options, FX and crypto from *one* engine — so when firm risk limits bind, the bid widens or withdraws across every world at once. XTX forecasts 50,000+ instruments across every asset class from a single engine [XTX]; Jane Street is a named Authorized Participant for spot-Bitcoin ETFs as well as a top equity and ETF maker [Blockworks]; Citadel Securities announced a crypto desk in 2025 [CoinDesk]. The documented failure mode: Wintermute halted quotes across ~60 venues in the October-2025 crash when its hedges broke [Decrypt].

SECTION 5 (CONTINUED)

Why one footprint, four forces

FORCE 3 · LEVERAGE & COLLATERAL

One margin call cascades a whole book

This force supplies the directional *force* and the *deadline*. A price move pushes a levered book past a threshold — a VaR limit, an exchange maintenance margin, a repo haircut re-set — triggering price-insensitive, deadline-driven selling that trips the next threshold. The documented anchor is the Treasury cash-futures basis trade: the OFR records \$2.5tn of hedge-fund repo financing of basis and curve trades and warns stress forces funds to "deleverage by unwinding positions" [OFR], run as high as ~50:1 [Fortune]. Its crypto analogue is the liquidation cascade — open interest and one-sided funding build clusters that act as fragility points [Glassnode]; the ~\$19bn October-2025 unwind showed market makers withdraw in lockstep once auto-deleveraging broke their hedges [Decrypt]. The trigger is a number, not a view — which is why "fade the capitulation" is an edge, and why mistaking forced flow for informed repricing is where it loses money.

FORCE 4 · FACTOR CROWDING

The identical signal, traded everywhere

This explains the most striking part of the footprint: the symmetric, both-direction trend cells that appear together in crypto, FX and equity indices. The object is time-series momentum [Moskowitz-Ooi-Pedersen] — one vol-scaled signal, long winners and short losers, run across hundreds of futures. AQR, Man AHL, Winton, Transtrend and Aspect all run it live and are measured on the same SG Trend benchmark [SG]; Man AHL's own research names crypto among its markets [Man]. Because the signal is direction-agnostic, one trigger level fires long-or-short orders across markets on the same day — and the sell side documents both legs, modelling ~\$33bn of CTA equity selling on a downside break and ~\$30bn of shorts whose covering drives the rallies [Goldman]. The both-direction symmetry is the crowd, not any one name.

The four forces **stack**. Crowding sets *where* stops and liquidation levels cluster — the same technical points across all worlds. Leverage supplies the price-insensitive force and the deadline once price arrives. Shared market makers pull the bid simultaneously, turning the move into a vacuum. The crowded longs and trend-followers are the *fuel*; the liquidity engineers and forced sellers are the flow that consumes it — which is why one read works on a staple, a coin, a currency and a barrel alike.

SECTION 5 (CONTINUED)

Three worked profiles

Each is selected for evidentiary strength, and each is an *evidenced hypothesis*: a public mandate that positions the actor to produce the footprint, never a claim that it did so on any given candle.

Jane Street — *the basket-arbitrage market maker*

Holds >10% of North-American equity trading and the leading ETF market-maker share, ran ~\$700bn/month of ETF turnover, and is a named Authorized Participant for spot-Bitcoin ETFs [Blockworks · GlobalTrading]. **Cross-asset concern:** the ETF create/redeem mandate makes the book structurally long-and-short ETF-versus-basket pairs across equity, bond *and* crypto at once, so the same absorb-and-hedge logic recurs in every world. **Caveat:** the AP active on a given day is not public, and the disputed SEBI interim order [Business Standard · CNBC] is kept only as the documented *shape* of the archetype — not a finding of manipulation.

ExodusPoint — *the self-disclosed levered-basis book*

The rare case confirmed by the holder: its own investor letter disclosed that the Treasury basis trade lifted quarter-end performance, with basis and rates over a fifth of risk allocation and explicitly named FX, commodity and government-bond legs [Investing.com]; it sits among the funds running that trade toward ~50:1 [Fortune]. **Cross-asset concern:** one global-macro risk engine holds Treasury basis, FX carry and equity-index futures as a single correlated complex, so a repo or haircut shock forcing the unwind propagates to the other legs under one VaR. **Caveat:** the letter confirms the book, not any specific forced sale.

The systematic-trend cohort — *the symmetric cells*

AQR — the source of the time-series-momentum result and a live operator — with Man AHL, Winton, Transtrend and Aspect, all measured on the same SG Trend benchmark and several sharing AHL lineage [SG · AQR · Man]. **Cross-asset concern:** one medium-term trend factor replicated across ~10 of the largest funds, with overlapping prime brokers and the same modelled trigger levels, fires correlated long-or-short orders across equity indices and FX on the same day — the direct generator of the both-direction cells. **Caveat (load-bearing):** the crypto leg is thinnest — SOL specifically is risk-on beta spillover, not documented trend positioning, and Transtrend has publicly declined bitcoin futures [Transtrend]. The defensible attribution is to the crowd, not any single fund.

SECTION 5 (CONTINUED)

The argument, and its limits

The claim is deliberately narrow. A documented population of cross-asset balance sheets, risk engines, market-maker inventories and trend signals is *structurally positioned to produce* the recurring footprint, evidenced by public fact. It is not trade-level attribution — that is unprovable from public data, and is not claimed.

Where the evidence is strong, and where it is thin. The strongest direct evidence is the ExodusPoint self-disclosed multi-leg book and the Goldman/BofA both-direction CTA models — public, holder- or desk-confirmed. The weakest, explicitly flagged, is the SOL-specific crypto leg, which is risk-on beta spillover rather than confirmed positioning. The standing caveat is regime-dependence: the cross-asset correlation that powers the unified footprint is sharp in risk-off and vol-spike regimes and can decouple in calm or idiosyncratic episodes. The honest summary is that the evidence justifies the hypothesis and does not close it.

Selected sources

BIS 90 · Market turbulence & the Aug-2024 carry unwind — bis.org/publ/bisbull90.htm

GSAM · Hedge funds in a new market regime (concentration; synchronised deleveraging) — am.gs.com

OFR · Hedge Fund Monitor Q4-2024 (\$2.5tn repo basis financing) — financialresearch.gov

Fortune · Hedge funds, the basis trade & ~50:1 leverage — fortune.com

Investing.com · ExodusPoint quarter-end lifted by the basis trade (letter) — investing.com

XTX · 50,000+ instruments, one ML engine; largest spot-FX LP — xtxmarkets.com

Blockworks · Jane Street as spot-Bitcoin-ETF Authorized Participant — blockworks.com

CoinDesk · Citadel Securities plans crypto market-making (Feb 2025) — coindesk.com

Decrypt · Why Wintermute & other MMs withdrew (Oct-2025 ADL break) — decrypt.co

Glassnode · Liquidation heatmaps & cluster fragility — research.glassnode.com

Moskowitz-Ooi-Pedersen · Time-Series Momentum, JFE 2012 — aqr.com

Man · SG · Trend market mix incl. crypto; SG Trend Index — man.com · societegenerale.com

Goldman · BofA · Level-triggered, both-direction CTA models — Analytics Insight · [Investing.com](https://investing.com)

LSEG · BTC-Nasdaq correlation, regime-dependent — via Yahoo Finance

SECTION 6

Limitations and forward work

The figures in this document are in-sample. The programme below is the standard by which the research is held — the work that separates a strong backtest from a track record. The same discipline is applied to the research itself.

THE VALIDATION STANDARD

TEST	STATUS	NOTE
Commission & slippage	Modelled	Applied to every backtest; all figures are net of costs, not gross.
Capacity	Structural	The book is liquid large-caps and major ETFs that absorb size; the precise ceiling is not yet formally measured.
Out-of-sample	Pending — next	A held-out window the engine has never seen; the immediate priority, and the gate every deep-tuned recipe waits behind.
Walk-forward	Planned	Rolling re-optimisation and re-test, to show each per-symbol recipe is stable through time rather than fitted to one window.
Monte Carlo	Planned	Trade-order and return resampling, to bound the distribution of outcomes and the risk of ruin under sizing.
Live record	The bar	A forward, time-stamped track record — the only dispositive evidence for a fund or licensing conversation.

The strongest cells in the book are long-only fades through a secular-bull window; their high win rates are the clearest sign that out-of-sample work is owed, not optional. The honest summary of the present state is this: the evidence is strong enough to justify that work, and not yet a substitute for it. Nineteen of the 107 are explicitly held back for re-tuning; the remaining instruments in the 130+ universe are under profile. The 24 symmetric both-direction cells — across FX (AUDJPY, USDCAD, GBPUSD), crypto (SOL, AVAX, ENA), equities (KO, NXPI, PEP) and commodities (NATGASUSD) — are the exception that strengthens the case: they survive a regime flip and do not depend on the bull window.

SECTION 7

The system, and access

The research is delivered as three instruments, invite-only on TradingView. One engine decides the trade; two companions make its ranking and its risk legible.

LIQUIDEX
THE ENGINE

5,000+ lines of Pine v6. Reads liquidation cascades, order flow, order blocks, iceberg walls and liquidity sweeps, and resolves them into one position — entry, structural stop, and a target at the opposing wall.

Keeper
LIVE RANKING

Runs the engine across the whole book and ranks every name live by profit factor, momentum and risk — so the operator sees the leader the engine prefers, not a guess.

Prophet
RISK GATE

Makes directional risk visible — a composite score, safe and danger zones, and a live position-size verdict that trims exposure as risk rises and stands the operator down in the danger zone.

ACCESS & PARTNERSHIP

Operators receive invite-only access on TradingView: send a TradingView username, access is granted, and the signals arrive as alerts on phone, desktop or a connected trading bot. Access and pricing are available on request.

The defensible asset is the method — a protocol for reading the institutional desks behind the order flow that reproduces across the universe, equities and macro alike. It is open to licensing, a strategic research partnership, or full acquisition.

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